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Hiring Manager
Acuity

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I'm writing to apply for the Software Engineer (Python, AI) role at Acuity. I'm a software engineer with a Ph.D. in Computational Finance and over four years of production experience building backend systems, REST APIs, and AI-driven infrastructure, and I'm drawn to Acuity's focus on using AI to solve real-world problems within a cloud-native, Agile engineering culture.

At the UK Data Service, I spent two and a half years building and operating Python-based ML systems in production: training and deploying PyTorch and scikit-learn models with Hugging Face, vLLM, and Ollama for automated metadata classification, and designing AWS-based retraining pipelines (Lambda, Step Functions, EFS) with drift monitoring that cut manual intervention by 50%. I also built ETL pipelines against PostgreSQL datasets of 100K+ records to feed those models, and rewrote a performance-critical disclosure-control algorithm from R to C++, achieving an 11x speedup for real-time processing at scale. That combination of Python, cloud infrastructure, and production ML is close to the core of what this role asks for.

In my current role at the University of Essex, I've built GitHub Actions and Vercel CI/CD pipelines supporting automated testing and weekly release cycles for a multi-team internal platform, and stood up MLOps infrastructure serving multiple engineering and research teams. I also integrated the OpenAI API into a native mobile app used by field technicians, turning raw photo, audio, and text input into well-formed reports written directly to a database — direct experience shipping AI features that solve a concrete business problem, which is exactly the kind of work Acuity's job description calls out.

Across both roles and in my own projects, I've worked with REST API design, Git-based branching workflows, and cross-functional collaboration with academics, product managers, and public sector clients, translating non-technical requirements into production specifications — skills that map directly onto Acuity's Agile, cross-team environment. While my recent API work has spanned Python, Go, and TypeScript rather than FastAPI or Flask specifically, I pick up frameworks quickly and I'm genuinely excited to deepen my focus on the modern Python stack (FastAPI, Pydantic, async programming) this role centers on.

I'd welcome the chance to bring this background to Acuity and to contribute to your AI-driven platforms on-site. Thank you for your time and consideration — I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how I can contribute to your team.

Kind regards,

Ivan Evdokimov